



Co-branded Guidelines

Subject: Musculoskeletal Services/ Procedures – eviCore Guidelines

In certain markets, Cigna delegates utilization management of specific services, including chiropractic care, physical and occupational therapy and advanced radiology services. In these situations, delegated vendor guidelines may be used to support medical necessity and other coverage determinations.

[eviCore Guidelines \(High Tech Imaging, Radiation Therapy and Musculoskeletal Services\)](#)

Musculoskeletal Services/Procedures

[Joint Surgery Quick Reference Guide](#)

[Interventional Pain Management Quick Reference Guide](#)

[Epidural Adhesiolysis \(CMM 207\)](#)

[Epidural Steroid Injections \(CMM 200\)](#)

[Facet Joint Injections/ Medial Branch Blocks \(CMM 201\)](#)

[Hip Arthroplasty – Total and Partial \(CMM 313\)](#)

[Hip Surgery – Arthroscopic and Open Procedures \(CMM 314\)](#)

[Implantable Intrathecal Drug Delivery Systems \(CMM 210\)](#)

[Knee Arthroplasty – Total and Partial \(CMM 311\)](#)

[Knee Surgery – Arthroscopic and Open Procedures \(CMM 312\)](#)

[Prolotherapy \(CMM 204\)](#)

[Radiofrequency Joint Ablations/Denervations \(CMM 208\)](#)

[Regional Sympathetic Blocks \(CMM 209\)](#)

[Sacroiliac Joint Injections \(CMM 203\)](#)

[Shoulder Arthroplasty – Total and Partial \(CMM 318\)](#)

[Shoulder Surgery – Arthroscopic and Open Procedures \(CMM 315\)](#)

[Spinal Cord and Implantable Peripheral Nerve Stimulators \(CMM 211\)](#)

These eviCore's clinical guidelines are evidence-based and apply to the following categories of service for individuals with Cigna-administered plans:

- Pain Management
- Major Joint Surgery

The terms of an individual's particular coverage plan document [Group Service Agreement (GSA), Evidence of Coverage, Certificate of Coverage, Summary Plan Description (SPD), or similar plan document] may differ significantly from the standard coverage plans upon which these guidelines are based. **If these clinical guidelines are inconsistent with the terms of the individual's specific coverage plan, then the terms of the individual's coverage plan always takes precedence.**

Coverage determinations in each specific instance require consideration of:

- The terms of the applicable coverage plan document in effect on the date of service
- Any applicable laws or regulations
- Any relevant collateral source materials including clinical guidelines
- The specific facts of the particular situation

eviCore's guidelines are based upon major national and international association and society guidelines and criteria, peer-reviewed literature, major treatises, and input from health plans, practicing academic and community-based physicians.

Medical technology is continuously evolving; the guidelines undergo a formal review annually, however eviCore reserves the right to change and update the guidelines without prior notice. Additional clinical guidelines may be developed as needed or may be withdrawn from use.

These guidelines are not intended to supersede or replace sound medical judgment, but instead should facilitate the identification of the most appropriate imaging procedure given the individual's clinical condition. These guidelines are written to cover medical conditions as experienced by the majority of individuals. However, these guidelines may not be applicable in certain clinical circumstances. eviCore's clinical guidelines may include information inapplicable to benefit plans administered by Cigna.

Clinical decisions, including treatment decisions, are the responsibility of the individual and his/her provider. Clinicians are expected to use independent medical judgment which takes into account the clinical circumstances to make individual management decisions.

eviCore supports the work of physicians and others who strive to reduce the overuse of diagnostic tests that are of low value, of no value, or where the risks of a given diagnostic test are greater than the benefits.

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